

Trinity powers past Avon Lake, 73-46

Chris Assenheimer
The Chronicle-Telegram

CLEVELAND — The much anticipated girls basketball confrontation, pitting defending Division II state champion Avon Lake, against last year's Division I titlist Trinity, turned out to be a one-team show, starting the Lady Trojans.

Trinity, a perennial state power, stole the wind from the Shoregals' sail early, coasting to a 73-46 victory, Friday night in the second game of the McDonald &

Company High School Tipoff Classic at Gund Arena.

Avon Lake, 1-1, came in focused on stopping the outside tandem of returning starters, junior Chrissy Falcone and sophomore Semeka Randall, who starred in the Lady Trojans' drive for the state crown a year ago.

But it was Trinity's inside game that took the Shoregals out of the contest early and dominated the offensive boards the entire night. Nineteen of the Lady Trojans' 34 total rebounds came underneath their own basket. The

recipients of most of those second chance buckets were forwards Kamilai Cunningham and Sasha King, who combined for 18 rebounds and 33 points.

"We got in trouble rebounding wise," said Avon Lake head coach Amy Manco, who tasted defeat for only the fourth time in 55 games on the Shoregal bench. "Our post play wasn't where it should be tonight. We did a pretty good job on Falcone, and we told the girls to box out the other kids, but we just didn't do it. I think we settled down a little bit in the second half,

but we were too far behind."

After trailing by seven at the end of the opening period, AL's Megan Chawansky converted a layup to cut the deficit to five points. That was as close as the Shoregals would get the rest of the way, though, as Randall got on track to spark a 10-2 second quarter run that hoisted the Trinity advantage back into double digits. The flashy guard scored 10 of her game-high 18 points in the contest's second eight minute segment.

The Shoregals needed a huge

game out of Chawansky, last season's Division II player of the year, if they had notions of pulling off the upset, and they didn't get it. The senior struggled from the field and uncharacteristically from the free throw line, where she hit just three of seven charity attempts, finishing the night with 16 points.

Manco said it was a case of the other players going to their money player too often.

"We looked too much to Megan," she said. "Everybody was afraid to do anything. Maybe it was the atmosphere. We start five

seniors, but most of them don't have big game experience."

A Lake	G	F	T	Trinity	G	F	T
Sandor	3	0	7	Falcone	2	2	2
Coughlin	3	0	9	Randall	1	0	16
Lipak	0	3	3	Woolcott	1	0	2
A Chawansky	0	0	0	Cunningham	7	3	17
M Chawansky	6	3	16	King	7	2	16
Powell	0	0	0	Todd	2	0	4
Zakel	0	5	5	Palgut	2	1	5
Sammors	1	0	2	Smith	2	0	4
Flum	1	2	4	Robinson	0	0	0
Casperlo	0	0	0	Palomski	0	0	0
Fulfer	0	0	0	Neuman	0	0	0
Pivovary	0	0	0				
Totals	13	14	46	Totals	32	8	73

Points by Quarters: 1 2 3 4 T
Trinity 12 19 21 17 — 73
A Lake 12 13 10 11 — 46

Three-point goals: Avon Lake, Coughlin 3 M Chawansky Trinity, Falcone

Firelands gets opening win

Erich Burnett
The Chronicle-Telegram

HENRIETTA — Wins are wins, no matter how ugly they may appear.

Firelands head coach Mike Horne may need to recite those words to himself countless times before the memory of Friday's contest against visiting Vermilion fades.

In a season opener that looked very much like a season opener, the Falcons grunted out a 72-63 victory over a Sailor squad that held tough before imploding midway through the fourth quarter.

Firelands was paced by senior forward Matt Varndell, who struck from both long and short range en route to a game-high 27 points.

At the game's outset, the Falcons controlled the opening tip and roared to a 5-0 lead only seconds into the quarter. The lead was extended to 10-2 following a three-point basket by senior Joe Potts.

The Sailors and Falcons proceeded to trade scoring runs of seven and eight points respectively before the period ended at 14-19.

Vermilion garnered the lead early in the second quarter on a fast-break layup and free throw by junior Brian Sheets. The Sailors turned the lead into a 37-31 half-time advantage, led by senior forward Ian Hollis' 10 points.

Throughout much of the first half, Vermilion found success

against Firelands' man-to-man defense, capitalizing on the Falcons' inability to adjust to Sailor picks.

"We pretty much wanted to stay with man-to-man," Horne said. "We kept getting caught in moving screens and they were getting points in the paint."

Firelands commenced the second half with a flurry, connecting on four three-point field goals (three by Varndell) to recapture the lead, 53-51 after three quarters.

"Our defense let up bad in the second half," lamented Vermilion coach Bob Walsh. "Our defense didn't do anything, but stand back and watch Varndell bomb threes."

Matters only became worse for the Sailors in the final quarter. After closing to within 55-54 on a free throw by junior forward Ed Cyrek, Vermilion watched as the Falcons reeled off 16 of the next 20 points, constructing a 13-point cushion with only a minute remaining. Poor shooting and careless passing compounded the Sailors' fourth quarter woes.

"We're a team that can not make mistakes, and we made mistakes," explained Walsh.

"We took several ill-advised shots. They went to a stand-up zone (defense) and we just threw the ball away."

Horne was similarly disgruntled with his team's performance.

"Our team play was not what I expected it to be, but we found a way to move the ball when it counted," he said



HE'S SURROUNDED: Firelands' senior Jared Chonko (42) gets off shot despite tight defense by Vermilion's Chris Parmenter (31) and Alan Doane (21).

Chanel edges Oberlin; Keystone wins opener

BEDFORD HTS. — Howard Chambers' game-high 23 points weren't quite enough as Oberlin dropped a heartbreaking 72-71 decision to Bedford Chanel in the Indians' season opener Friday night.

Mike Young and Greg Thomas joined Chambers in double figures with 16 and 10 points, respectively.

OBERLIN (71). Chambers 23, Hodge 6, Young 16, D Thomas 6, G Thomas 10, Barbra 2, Earl 2, Wilson 4, Lake 2.

CHANEL (72) Santiago 12, Cargile 5, Fann 8, Boyer 9, Johnson 4, Meenke 4, Evans 13, Kallman 8, Monestaro 9.

Points by Quarters: 1 2 3 4 T
Oberlin 12 24 8 26 — 71
Chanel 13 24 14 25 — 72

Keystone.....63
Brooklyn.....40

LAGRANGE — Mike Helbig and Rob Beckham combined for 27 points to pace Keystone to a 63-40 win over Brooklyn in non-conference action Friday night.

Helbig's game-high 14 points included four three-point baskets while Beckham totalled 13. Dave Siefert led the Hurricanes with 12 points in the two teams' season opener.

Points by Quarters: 1 2 3 4 T
Keystone 12 16 15 10 — 53
Brooklyn 11 9 7 15 — 40

Three-point goals: Keystone, Helbig 4, Holzhauer, Kinect, Rodak, Junior Varsity: Brooklyn, 55-54 (OT)

Midpark

G	F	T	Bay	G	F	T	
Lechuk	3	0	9	Masterston	7	7	22
Peurck	3	0	7	Scott	3	0	6
Rains	2	0	5	Mussulin	1	0	4
Cwarski	0	3	3	Miller	5	2	17
Czech	4	0	10	Garry	7	2	16
Cocherchi	3	7	14	Zan	1	0	2
Tomasinos	4	0	8	Rodgers	1	0	2
Totals	19	10	56	Totals	26	11	67

Points by Quarters

1	2	3	4	T	
Midpark	12	7	15	22	56
Bay	7	15	14	31	67

Three-point goals: Midpark, Lechuk 3, Czech 2, Pasark, Rains, Cocherchi, Bay, Miller 3 Masterston Junior Varsity: Bay won

Buckeye.....49
Columbia.....41

COLUMBIA STATION

Senior Josh Kutz's game-high 23 points led Buckeye to a season opening 49-41 win over Columbia in non-conference play Friday night.

Jason Blankenship added 14 for the Bucks, with two of his baskets coming from three-point land. Senior Paul Krenz paced the Raiders with 20.

Points by Quarters

G	F	T	Columbia	G	F	T	
Bowie	1	0	1	Skor	2	0	4
Anders	0	4	4	Schermann	0	2	2
Shaw	1	0	2	Morgan	1	1	3
Coleman	1	0	2	Berlin	1	2	4
Blankenship	6	14	20	Reddy	4	0	8
Kutz	8	9	25	Krenz	9	2	20
Totals	17	13	49	Totals	17	4	21

Points by Quarters

1	2	3	4	T	
Buckeye	5	14	9	21	49
Columbia	12	4	9	16	41

Three-point goals: Buckeye, Blankenship 2 Junior Varsity: Buckeye 42-24

Open Door.....49
Lake Ridge.....41

ELYRIA — Open Door jumped out to a 26-10 lead after one quarter Friday night en route to an easy 74-38 victory over Lake Ridge.

Olmsted Falls stops Brookside

Steve Byrne
The Chronicle-Telegram

OLMSTED FALLS — Kevin Monn ought to sit a little closer to the coach next time — for his own sake and the sake of the team.

"It was an oversight," Olmsted Falls coach Pat Donahue said when explaining why Monn was the Bulldogs' one returning letter winner who didn't play in the first half of Friday's boys basketball opener. "Kevin had been shooting real well in practice."

"I tried to get all 11 varsity guys some playing time in the first half just so they could be warm if we needed them in the second half. Then at halftime I look around the locker room and saw Kevin with his warmup jacket on."

Monn took the slight well enough to score 14 points in the third and fourth quarters to spark the Bulldogs to a 68-48 victory over Brookside.

His team needed it. The Cardinals had cut an 11-point lead to three early in the third quarter as some of the Bulldogs, particularly 3-point shooter Tim Matus, were having trouble seeing their shots fall.

"I'm going to be conservative when I tell you Tim hit about 18 or 19 of his 3-point attempts out of 30 in our three scrimmages," Donahue said. "He couldn't

believe they weren't falling for him tonight, but he kept shooting."

Monn's accuracy must have been contagious. Matus scored 12 of his 14 points in the second half. He buried his first 3-pointer with 3:48 to go in the third period.

Four Bulldogs scored in double figures. Matt Taber led the way with 16 and Tim Schaefer finished with 13. Nick Neumeister and Schaefer grabbed 10 and nine rebounds respectively.

"Falls didn't do anything we didn't expect," Brookside coach Gene Leonard said. "A couple of shots didn't fall and then we lost confidence in our shooting. We can't have that."

The Cards made only three of their first 19 shots in the second half.

Olmsted Falls hit 16 of 27 field goal attempts in the second half and led by as many as 20 points.

Brookside

G	F	T	O Falls	G	F	T	
Vinght	1	2	4	Deliso	2	1	5
Mahon	1	0	24	Matus	6	0	14
McFeeture	2	0	4	Taber	7	0	16
Kusnick	1	0	2	Neumeister	2	0	4
Connelly	3	2	8	Schaefer	6	1	13
Boh Posso	1	4	6	Morrin	0	1	14
Beau	0	0	0	Moore	0	0	0
Rosso	0	0	0	Stappen-backer	1	0	2
Hess	0	0	0	Higgins	0	0	0
Totals	19	8	48	Totals	30	3	68

Points by Quarters: 1 2 3 4 T
Brookside 9 17 9 13 — 48
Olmsted Falls 24 11 20 17 — 68

Three-point goals: Mahon 2, Matus 2, Taber 2 (Monn)

Junior Varsity: Olmsted Falls 55-55 (OT)

PIONEERS

From C1

The Pioneers made just seven of 35 shots.

"We missed 13 shots in the paint in the first half," said coach Mike Walsh, making his debut on the varsity bench. "And we missed 10 free throws, but we were only behind by four points."

Meanwhile, Shaker was blazing away, ripping the nets for 60 percent shooting on 31 of 51, despite a makeshift lineup. Coach Bob Wonson benched three starters who were late for practice.

One of them, junior Jermaine Kimbrough, came off the bench and poured in 29 points. Kimbrough was All-Lake Erie League last year as a sophomore.

Despite its problems, Elyria had its chances, scoring the first four points of the second half to tie the game at 34. A little more than three minutes into the second half it was 42-39, but Shaker dominated the last quarter and a half.

"We put Elyria on the line too much in the first half," said Wonson. "We had trouble rebounding the basketball, even though we're bigger than they are. They got us into foul trouble, but we were still ahead. We played a little smarter in the second half."

Walsh thought his team did a good job defensively until it was forced to gamble in the fourth quarter.

"We were behind 55-45 and we asked them if they wanted to lose

by 10 or try to make a run at them," Walsh said. "We decided to go get them and see what happened. It cost us."

Nevertheless, Elyria had some encouraging performances, especially from junior Lyle Brown and senior Chris Reddinger. Brown had 16 points and Reddinger nine. Both did a great job battling on the boards.

Larrick had 15 — 11 from the free throw line — and Mark Gatewood came off the bench to score 10 for Elyria.

The Pioneer jayvees also ran out of gas in the fourth quarter and were routed 81-44 by Shaker. Will Oliver had 14 and Brian Hopkins 10 for coach John Smit's Pioneers.

ELYRIA (58)

G	F	A	FA	F	P
Bray Todd	1	2	1	1	3
Lyle Brown	14	5	10	6	16
C Reddinger	9	2	6	5	2
Isaac Johnson	2	0	4	2	4
Adam Lamck	14	2	14	11	2
Gus Andge	0	0	0	2	1
M Gatewood	11	4	0	2	15
J. Smittinger	4	1	0	0	2
Jack Blawacke	1	0	0	0	0
Danny Martin	1	0	0	0	0
Corey Dennis	0	0	0	0	0
Alene Payne	0	0	0	0	0
Rick Tukur	0	0	0	0	0
TOTALS	64	15	38	26	58

SHAKER HEIGHTS (84)

G	F	A	FA	F	P
Michael Sims	6	5	2	1	11
Sean Maene	7	1	2	1	3
Kamark Hum	2	2	0	0	4
Delmar Goodwin	4	1	2	1	3
Rashon Brown	3	2	4	2	6
Andie Pur	0	0	0	0	1
Preston Reate	7	0	0	0	9
Shawn Wright	9	5	5	1	3
Marcus Hall	7	3	5	3	9
J Kimbrough	15	11	5	1	29
Tim Drewis	2	1	5	1	4
TOTALS	51	31	28	17	84

Three-point field goals: Elyria (2-16) Brown 0-1, Smittinger 0-2, Lamck 0-7, Tukur 0-1, Gatewood 2-5, Shaker Heights (5-14) Watson 1-2, Kimbrough 1-4, Goodwin 0-2, Reate 3-6

SCORE BY QUARTERS: 1 2 3 4 T
Elyria 12 18 15 13 — 58
Shaker Hts 16 18 19 31 — 84

Junior Varsity: Shaker Heights, 81-44

Westlake.....75
Berea.....58

WESTLAKE — Westlake's deeper bench paid off in the second half as the Demons opened up their schedule with a 75-58 non-conference victory over Berea.

Zac Fiebig and Bret Fisher topped the winners with a game-high 19 points apiece while Jason Hamann contributed 14.

Points by Quarters: 1 2 3 4 T
Westlake 16 18 9 15 — 58
Berea 24 21 18 12 — 75

Three-point goals: Westlake, Fiebig 4, Hirsch, Cassidy, Westlake Fiebig 2, Myer 3

Bay.....67
Midpark.....56

BAY VILLAGE — Michael Masterson and Bob Miller combined for 14 points in the fourth quarter to pace Bay to a 67-56 triumph over non-conference foe Midpark Friday night in the two teams' season opener.

Masterson wound up with a game-high 22 points, while Miller (17) and Frank Garrity (16) joined him in double figures for the Rockets.

in non-conference action

Kevin Delestathis led the Patriots with 16 points, with Tim Turnick contributing 13 to the ODE scoreboard.

Lake Ridge

	G	F	T	OpenDoor	G	F	T
Sparrow	2	4	8	VWingrich	0	0	0
Dingis	1	2	4	Hudson	1	0	2
Bull	2	5	14	Matthews	4	2	11
Sweet	2	4	6	Tumuk	6	0	13
Higg-Grim-burg	2	2	6	Cooksey	3	0	6
Neville	5	0	11				
Dists	2	2	16				
Faulgr	2	1	5				
Powell	1	0	2				
Koch	2	0	2				
Walls	1	0	2				
McCord	1	0	2				
Totals	12	14	38	Totals	33	5	74

Points by Quarters

	1	2	3	4	T
Lake Ridge	10	10	10	8	38
OpenDoor	26	17	10	21	74

Three-point goals: Open Door, Matthews, Turnick, Neville

Junior Varsity: Open Door, 30-29

Hillsdale7

Mapleton5

ASHLAND — Josh Bargar's 15 points, including six three-point baskets, led Hillsdale to a 76-40 non-conference win over Mapleton Friday night.

	G	F	T	Mapleton	G	F	T
M Bargar	7	7	15	Bregar	4	2	10
Fickes	2	0	5	Cole	0	0	0
J Bargar	6	1	23	Donnelly	2	2	10
Frogers	2	0	4	Goon	0	0	0
Dave	4	0	9	Harter	1	1	3
Ferguson	4	3	11	Harper	0	0	0
Bentler	3	1	7	Ismann	3	0	8
Taylor	0	2	2	Ringler	3	1	5
Bahrer	0	0	0	Reed	0	0	0
Hersel	0	0	0	Sanders	0	0	0
				Walsh	0	0	0
Totals	30	8	76	Totals	19	12	54

Points by Quarters

	1	2	3	4	T
Hillsdale	25	17	14	20	76
Mapleton	14	9	16	15	54

Three-point goals: Hillsdale, Fickes, J Bargar, Dave, Mapleton, Donnelly, Ismann, 2 Ringler

Junior Varsity: Hillsdale, 30-29

MIDVIEW

From C1

halftime after trailing 45-32 through two periods. Daimon Mahone, who led his team with 17 points, hit a pair of layups and a tip-in while Rob Woolbright, who finished with 14, scored quickly on a pair of jumpers to help cut the Middle margin to 46-40.

Then, in the closing 20 seconds, Jason Woodyard dropped a long jumper and a fast break layup to narrow the lead to 53-48 with eight minutes to play.

Midview led only 58-52 early in the final quarter, but Stacey sandwiched a pair of layups around a three-pointer by Miller to raise the score to 66-52 at the 4:47 mark. It was just a matter of counting down the minutes from there.

Then, in the closing 20 seconds, Jason Woodyard dropped a long jumper and a fast break layup to narrow the lead to 53-48 with eight minutes to play.

"I'm disappointed with the loss, but I'm really proud of the way our kids came back and put us right back into it," Mohr said.

Verba was satisfied with his entire team's play.

"Nobody really hurt us," he said. "Overall, the kids, without that much experience, held up

real well."

Mohr felt the same about his squad.

"Daimon Mahone had a gutsy effort," he said. "Woolbright played a solid game. We had solid performances from a number of people."

The West junior varsity won 53-44 with Ian Robinson scoring 17 points and Eric Evans 10. Scott Busler led the young Middies with 11.

Elyria West is at Bay Tuesday for another non-conference game while Midview is off until Friday when it travels to Wellington

Midview

G	F	A	FA	F	P
Anthony Stacey	21	14	12	13	2
Kevin Klein	4	3	9	1	6
Jimmy Miller	7	4	2	1	2
Andrew Ebert	7	4	2	1	2
Crake Mosby	5	3	0	0	6
Damon Young	3	2	3	1	2
Eric Bridge	3	1	0	0	0
Kris Cawford	7	3	0	0	2
Kevin Hoffmann	0	0	0	0	0
Ron Jackson	0	0	0	0	0
Kyle Fisher	1	0	0	0	0
TOTALS	61	31	14	11	76

ELYRIA WEST

G	F	A	FA	F	P
Daimon Mahone	14	7	3	2	17
Rob Woolbright	9	7	3	2	5
Brad Schell	7	2	2	1	7
Jason Woodyard	7	2	2	1	7
Manuz Weaver	12	3	0	0	6
Chauncey Bowen	5	1	2	0	0
Ben Pyles	3	2	1	0	0
Darin Terry	3	2	0	0	0
Andre Taylor	1	0	0	0	1
Brian Jenkins	1	0	0	0	0
Chris Tarnack	5	2	0	0	4
TOTALS	63	27	12	6	62

Score by Quarters: 1 2 3 4 T
Midview 24 21 8 23 — 76
Elyria West 12 20 16 14 — 62

Three-point Goals: Midview: Jimmy, Miller 1
Elyria West: Daimon Mahone, Chauncey Bowen
Junior Varsity: Elyria West 53-44

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